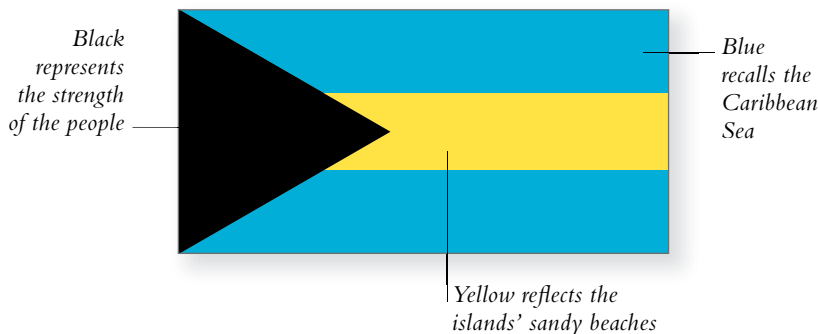


Bahamas

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** July 10, 1973 **Usage:** National



North America



Originally a pirate base, the **Bahamas** became a formal British colony in 1783. It did not achieve independence until July 10, 1973.

The colors of the flag are intended to represent the aquamarine seas around the islands and their golden sands. The flag is based on designs by the Bahamian people. Many of those submitted also included the idea of sunrise, which has been incorporated into the coat of arms.

The Bahamas Civil Ensign (flown by merchant ships) is often

seen, since many ships are registered in the Bahamas. The flag is based on the British Red Ensign—red with a Bahamian national flag in the canton—but is distinguished by the white cross, like the Cross of St. George, across the red field.

The Bahamas has many other flags including one for the specific use of the Prime Minister.

BAHAMAS CIVIL ENSIGN

